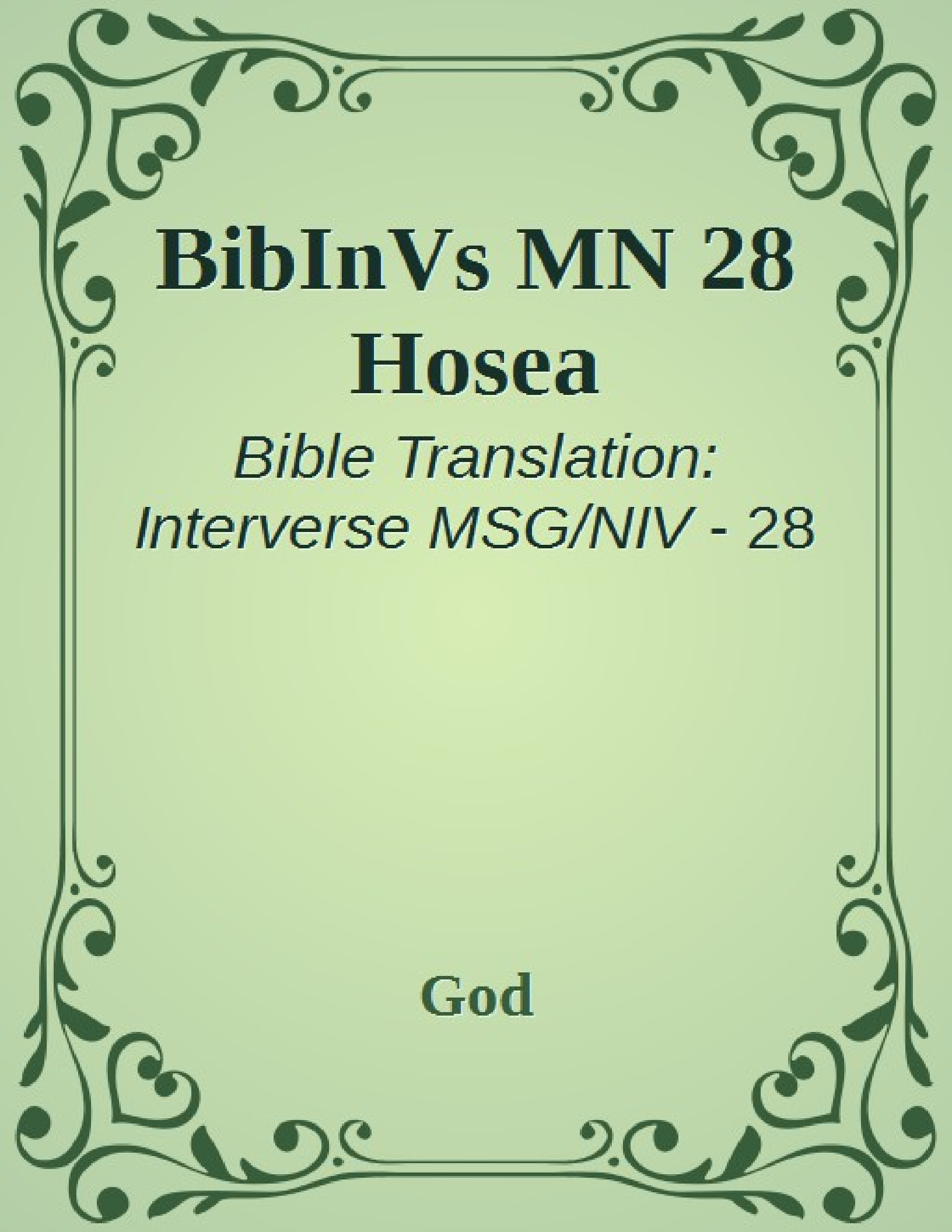


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 28

Hosea

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 28*

God

Table of Contents

[Hosea 1](#)
[Hosea 2](#)
[Hosea 3](#)
[Hosea 4](#)
[Hosea 5](#)
[Hosea 6](#)
[Hosea 7](#)
[Hosea 8](#)
[Hosea 9](#)
[Hosea 10](#)
[Hosea 11](#)
[Hosea 12](#)
[Hosea 13](#)
[Hosea 14](#)

Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Hosea

Hosea 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 This is God's Message to Hosea son of Beeri. It came to him during the royal reigns of Judah's kings Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah. This was also the time that Jeroboam son of Joash was king over Israel.
- 1 The word of the LORD that came to Hosea son of Beeri during the reigns of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, and during the reign of Jeroboam son of Jehoash king of Israel:
- 2 The first time GOD spoke to Hosea he said: "Find a whore and marry her. Make this whore the mother of your children. And here's why: This whole country has become a whorehouse, unfaithful to me, GOD."
- 2 When the LORD began to speak through Hosea, the LORD said to him, "Go, take to yourself an adulterous wife and children of unfaithfulness, because the land is guilty of the vilest adultery in departing from the LORD."
- 3 Hosea did it. He picked Gomer daughter of Diblaim. She got pregnant and gave him a son.
- 3 So he married Gomer daughter of Diblaim, and she conceived and bore him a son.
- 4 Then GOD told him: "Name him Jezreel. It won't be long now before I'll make the people of Israel pay for the massacre at Jezreel. I'm calling it quits on the kingdom of Israel.
- 4 Then the LORD said to Hosea, "Call him Jezreel, because I will soon punish the house of Jehu for the massacre at Jezreel, and I will put an end to the kingdom of Israel.
- 5 Payday is coming! I'm going to chop Israel's bows and arrows into kindling in the valley of Jezreel."
- 5 In that day I will break Israel's bow in the Valley of Jezreel."

- 6 Gomer got pregnant again. This time she had a daughter. GOD told Hosea: "Name this one No-Mercy. I'm fed up with Israel. I've run out of mercy. There's no more forgiveness.
- 6 Gomer conceived again and gave birth to a daughter. Then the LORD said to Hosea, "Call her Lo-Ruhamah, for I will no longer show love to the house of Israel, that I should at all forgive them.
- 7 Judah's another story. I'll continue having mercy on them. I'll save them. It will be their GOD who saves them, Not their armaments and armies, not their horsepower and manpower."
- 7 Yet I will show love to the house of Judah; and I will save them-- not by bow, sword or battle, or by horses and horsemen, but by the LORD their God."
- 8 After Gomer had weaned No-Mercy, she got pregnant yet again and had a son.
- 8 After she had weaned Lo-Ruhamah, Gomer had another son.
- 9 GOD said: "Name him Nobody. You've become nobodies to me, and I, GOD, am a nobody to you.
- 9 Then the LORD said, "Call him Lo-Ammi, for you are not my people, and I am not your God.
- 10 "But down the road the population of Israel is going to explode past counting, like sand on the ocean beaches. In the very place where they were once named Nobody, they will be named God's Somebody.
- 10 Yet the Israelites will be like the sand on the seashore, which cannot be measured or counted. In the place where it was said to them, 'You are not my people,' they will be called 'sons of the living God.'
- 11 Everybody in Judah and everybody in Israel will be assembled as one people. They'll choose a single leader. There'll be no stopping them--a great day in Jezreel!
- 11 The people of Judah and the people of Israel will be reunited, and they will appoint one leader and will come up out of the land, for great will be the day of Jezreel.

Hosea 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Rename your brothers 'God's Somebody.' Rename your sisters 'All Mercy.'
- 1 Say of your brothers, 'My people,' and of your sisters, 'My loved one.'
- 2 "Haul your mother into court. Accuse her! She's no longer my wife. I'm no longer her husband. Tell her to quit dressing like a whore, displaying her breasts for sale.
- 2 Rebuke your mother, rebuke her, for she is not my wife, and I am not her husband. Let her remove the adulterous look from her face and the unfaithfulness from between her breasts.
- 3 If she refuses, I'll rip off her clothes and expose her, naked as a newborn. I'll turn her skin into dried-out leather, her body into a badlands landscape, a rack of bones in the desert.
- 3 Otherwise I will strip her naked and make her as bare as on the day she was born; I will make her like a desert, turn her into a parched land, and slay her with thirst.
- 4 I'll have nothing to do with her children, born one and all in a whorehouse.
- 4 I will not show my love to her children, because they are the children of adultery.
- 5 Face it: Your mother's been a whore, bringing bastard children into the world. She said, 'I'm off to see my lovers! They'll wine and dine me, Dress and caress me, perfume and adorn me!'
- 5 Their mother has been unfaithful and has conceived them in disgrace. She said, 'I will go after my lovers, who give me my food and my water, my wool and my linen, my oil and my drink.'
- 6 But I'll fix her: I'll dump her in a field of thistles, then lose her in a dead-end alley.
- 6 Therefore I will block her path with thornbushes; I will wall her in so that she cannot find her way.
- 7 She'll go on the hunt for her lovers but not bring down a single one. She'll look high and low but won't find a one. Then she'll say, 'I'm going back to my husband, the one I started out with. That was a better life by far than this one.'
- 7 She will chase after her lovers but not catch them; she will look for them but not find them. Then she will say, 'I will go back to my husband as at first, for then I was better off than now.'

- 8 She didn't know that it was I all along who wined and dined and adorned her, That I was the one who dressed her up in the big-city fashions and jewelry that she wasted on wild Baal-orgies.
- 8 She has not acknowledged that I was the one who gave her the grain, the new wine and oil, who lavished on her the silver and gold-- which they used for Baal.
- 9 I'm about to bring her up short: No more wining and dining! Silk lingerie and gowns are a thing of the past.
- 9 Therefore I will take away my grain when it ripens, and my new wine when it is ready. I will take back my wool and my linen, intended to cover her nakedness.
- 10 I'll expose her genitals to the public. All her fly-by-night lovers will be helpless to help her.
- 10 So now I will expose her lewdness before the eyes of her lovers; no one will take her out of my hands.
- 11 Party time is over. I'm calling a halt to the whole business, her wild weekends and unholy holidays.
- 11 I will stop all her celebrations: her yearly festivals, her New Moons, her Sabbath days--all her appointed feasts.
- 12 I'll wreck her sumptuous gardens and ornamental fountains, of which she bragged, 'Whoring paid for all this!' They will soon be dumping grounds for garbage, feeding grounds for stray dogs and cats.
- 12 I will ruin her vines and her fig trees, which she said were her pay from her lovers; I will make them a thicket, and wild animals will devour them.
- 13 I'll make her pay for her indulgence in promiscuous religion-- all that sensuous Baal worship And all the promiscuous sex that went with it, stalking her lovers, dressed to kill, And not a thought for me." GOD's Message!
- 13 I will punish her for the days she burned incense to the Baals; she decked herself with rings and jewelry, and went after her lovers, but me she forgot," declares the LORD.
- 14 "And now, here's what I'm going to do: I'm going to start all over again. I'm taking her back out into the wilderness where we had our first date, and I'll court her.

- 14 Therefore I am now going to allure her; I will lead her into the desert and speak tenderly to her.
- 15 I'll give her bouquets of roses. I'll turn Heartbreak Valley into Acres of Hope. She'll respond like she did as a young girl, those days when she was fresh out of Egypt.
- 15 There I will give her back her vineyards, and will make the Valley of Achor a door of hope. There she will sing as in the days of her youth, as in the day she came up out of Egypt.
- 16 "At that time"--this is GOD's Message still-- "you'll address me, 'Dear husband!' Never again will you address me, 'My slave-master!'"
- 16 In that day, declares the LORD, "you will call me 'my husband'; you will no longer call me 'my master. '
- 17 I'll wash your mouth out with soap, get rid of all the dirty false-god names, not so much as a whisper of those names again.
- 17 I will remove the names of the Baals from her lips; no longer will their names be invoked.
- 18 At the same time I'll make a peace treaty between you and wild animals and birds and reptiles, And get rid of all weapons of war. Think of it! Safe from beasts and bullies!
- 18 In that day I will make a covenant for them with the beasts of the field and the birds of the air and the creatures that move along the ground. Bow and sword and battle I will abolish from the land, so that all may lie down in safety.
- 19 And then I'll marry you for good--forever! I'll marry you true and proper, in love and tenderness.
- 19 I will betroth you to me forever; I will betroth you in righteousness and justice, in love and compassion.
- 20 Yes, I'll marry you and neither leave you nor let you go. You'll know me, GOD, for who I really am.
- 20 I will betroth you in faithfulness, and you will acknowledge the LORD.
- 21 "On the very same day, I'll answer"--this is GOD's Message-- "I'll answer the sky, sky will answer earth,
- 21 In that day I will respond, declares the LORD-- "I will respond to the skies, and they will respond to the earth;
- 22 Earth will answer grain and wine and olive oil, and they'll all answer Jezreel.

- 22 and the earth will respond to the grain, the new wine and oil, and they will respond to Jezreel.
- 23 I'll plant her in the good earth. I'll have mercy on No-Mercy. I'll say to Nobody, 'You're my dear Somebody,' and he'll say 'You're my God!'"
- 23 I will plant her for myself in the land; I will show my love to the one I called 'Not my loved one. ' I will say to those called 'Not my people, ' 'You are my people'; and they will say, 'You are my God.' "

Hosea 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then GOD ordered me, "Start all over: Love your wife again, your wife who's in bed with her latest boyfriend, your cheating wife. Love her the way I, GOD, love the Israelite people, even as they flirt and party with every god that takes their fancy."
- 1 The LORD said to me, "Go, show your love to your wife again, though she is loved by another and is an adulteress. Love her as the LORD loves the Israelites, though they turn to other gods and love the sacred raisin cakes."
- 2 I did it. I paid good money to get her back. It cost me the price of a slave.
- 2 So I bought her for fifteen shekels of silver and about a homer and a lethek of barley.
- 3 Then I told her, "From now on you're living with me. No more whoring, no more sleeping around. You're living with me and I'm living with you."
- 3 Then I told her, "You are to live with me many days; you must not be a prostitute or be intimate with any man, and I will live with you."
- 4 The people of Israel are going to live a long time stripped of security and protection, without religion and comfort, godless and prayerless.
- 4 For the Israelites will live many days without king or prince, without sacrifice or sacred stones, without ephod or idol.
- 5 But in time they'll come back, these Israelites, come back looking for their GOD and their David-King. They'll come back chastened to reverence before GOD and his good gifts, ready for the End of the story of his love.

- 5 Afterward the Israelites will return and seek the LORD their God and David their king. They will come trembling to the LORD and to his blessings in the last days.

Hosea 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Attention all Israelites! GOD's Message! GOD indicts the whole population: "No one is faithful. No one loves. No one knows the first thing about God.
- 1 Hear the word of the LORD, you Israelites, because the LORD has a charge to bring against you who live in the land: "There is no faithfulness, no love, no acknowledgment of God in the land.
- 2 All this cussing and lying and killing, theft and loose sex, sheer anarchy, one murder after another!
- 2 There is only cursing, lying and murder, stealing and adultery; they break all bounds, and bloodshed follows bloodshed.
- 3 And because of all this, the very land itself weeps and everything in it is grief-stricken-- animals in the fields and birds on the wing, even the fish in the sea are listless, lifeless.
- 3 Because of this the land mourns, and all who live in it waste away; the beasts of the field and the birds of the air and the fish of the sea are dying.
- 4 "But don't look for someone to blame. No finger pointing! You, priest, are the one in the dock.
- 4 But let no man bring a charge, let no man accuse another, for your people are like those who bring charges against a priest.
- 5 You stumble around in broad daylight, And then the prophets take over and stumble all night. Your mother is as bad as you.
- 5 You stumble day and night, and the prophets stumble with you. So I will destroy your mother--
- 6 My people are ruined because they don't know what's right or true. Because you've turned your back on knowledge, I've turned my back on you priests. Because you refuse to recognize the revelation of God, I'm no longer recognizing your children.

- 6 my people are destroyed from lack of knowledge. "Because you have rejected knowledge, I also reject you as my priests; because you have ignored the law of your God, I also will ignore your children.
- 7 The more priests, the more sin. They traded in their glory for shame.
- 7 The more the priests increased, the more they sinned against me; they exchanged their Glory for something disgraceful.
- 8 They pig out on my people's sins. They can't wait for the latest in evil.
- 8 They feed on the sins of my people and relish their wickedness.
- 9 The result: You can't tell the people from the priests, the priests from the people. I'm on my way to make them both pay and take the consequences of the bad lives they've lived.
- 9 And it will be: Like people, like priests. I will punish both of them for their ways and repay them for their deeds.
- 10 They'll eat and be as hungry as ever, have sex and get no satisfaction. They walked out on me, their GOD, for a life of rutting with whores.
- 10 They will eat but not have enough; they will engage in prostitution but not increase, because they have deserted the LORD to give themselves
- 11 "Wine and whiskey leave my people in a stupor.
- 11 to prostitution, to old wine and new, which take away the understanding
- 12 They ask questions of a dead tree, expect answers from a sturdy walking stick. Drunk on sex, they can't find their way home. They've replaced their God with their genitals.
- 12 of my people. They consult a wooden idol and are answered by a stick of wood. A spirit of prostitution leads them astray; they are unfaithful to their God.
- 13 They worship on the tops of mountains, make a picnic out of religion. Under the oaks and elms on the hills they stretch out and take it easy. Before you know it, your daughters are whores and the wives of your sons are sleeping around.
- 13 They sacrifice on the mountaintops and burn offerings on the hills, under oak, poplar and terebinth, where the shade is pleasant. Therefore your daughters turn to prostitution and your daughters-in-law to adultery.
- 14 But I'm not going after your whoring daughters or the adulterous wives of your sons. It's the men who pick up the whores that I'm after, the men who worship at the holy whorehouses-- a stupid people, ruined by whores!

- 14 I will not punish your daughters when they turn to prostitution, nor your daughters-in-law when they commit adultery, because the men themselves consort with harlots and sacrifice with shrine prostitutes-- a people without understanding will come to ruin!
- 15 "You've ruined your own life, Israel-- but don't drag Judah down with you! Don't go to the sex shrine at Gilgal, don't go to that sin city Bethel, Don't go around saying 'GOD bless you' and not mean it, taking God's name in vain.
- 15 Though you commit adultery, O Israel, let not Judah become guilty. Do not go to Gilgal; do not go up to Beth Aven. And do not swear, 'As surely as the LORD lives!'
- 16 Israel is stubborn as a mule. How can GOD lead him like a lamb to open pasture?
- 16 The Israelites are stubborn, like a stubborn heifer. How then can the LORD pasture them like lambs in a meadow?
- 17 Ephraim is addicted to idols. Let him go.
- 17 Ephraim is joined to idols; leave him alone!
- 18 When the beer runs out, it's sex, sex, and more sex. Bold and sordid debauchery-- how they love it!
- 18 Even when their drinks are gone, they continue their prostitution; their rulers dearly love shameful ways.
- 19 The whirlwind has them in its clutches. Their sex-worship leaves them finally impotent.
- 19 A whirlwind will sweep them away, and their sacrifices will bring them shame.

Hosea 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Listen to this, priests! Attention, people of Israel! Royal family--all ears! You're in charge of justice around here. But what have you done? Exploited people at Mizpah, ripped them off on Tabor,
- 1 Hear this, you priests! Pay attention, you Israelites! Listen, O royal house! This judgment is against you: You have been a snare at Mizpah, a net spread out on Tabor.

- 2 Victimized them at Shittim. I'm going to punish the lot of you.
- 2 The rebels are deep in slaughter. I will discipline all of them.
- 3 "I know you, Ephraim, inside and out. Yes, Israel, I see right through you! Ephraim, you've played your sex-and-religion games long enough. All Israel is thoroughly polluted.
- 3 I know all about Ephraim; Israel is not hidden from me. Ephraim, you have now turned to prostitution; Israel is corrupt.
- 4 They couldn't turn to God if they wanted to. Their evil life is a bad habit. Every breath they take is a whore's breath. They wouldn't recognize GOD if they saw me.
- 4 Their deeds do not permit them to return to their God. A spirit of prostitution is in their heart; they do not acknowledge the LORD.
- 5 "Bloated by arrogance, big as a house, they're a public disgrace, The lot of them--Israel, Ephraim, Judah-- lurching and weaving down their guilty streets.
- 5 Israel's arrogance testifies against them; the Israelites, even Ephraim, stumble in their sin; Judah also stumbles with them.
- 6 When they decide to get their lives together and go off looking for GOD once again, They'll find it's too late. I, GOD, will be long gone.
- 6 When they go with their flocks and herds to seek the LORD, they will not find him; he has withdrawn himself from them.
- 7 They've played fast and loose with me for too long, filling the country with their bastard offspring. A plague of locusts will devastate their violated land.
- 7 They are unfaithful to the LORD; they give birth to illegitimate children. Now their New Moon festivals will devour them and their fields.
- 8 "Blow the ram's horn shofar in Gibeah, the bugle in Ramah! Signal the invasion of Sin City! Scare the daylights out of Benjamin!
- 8 Sound the trumpet in Gibeah, the horn in Ramah. Raise the battle cry in Beth Aven; lead on, O Benjamin.
- 9 Ephraim will be left wasted, a lifeless moonscape. I'm telling it straight, the unvarnished truth, to the tribes of Israel.
- 9 Ephraim will be laid waste on the day of reckoning. Among the tribes of Israel I proclaim what is certain.
- 10 "Israel's rulers are crooks and thieves, cheating the people of their land, And I'm angry, good and angry. Every inch of their bodies is going to

- feel my anger.
- 10 Judah's leaders are like those who move boundary stones. I will pour out my wrath on them like a flood of water.
- 11 "Brutal Ephraim is himself brutalized-- a taste of his own medicine! He was so determined to do it his own worthless way.
- 11 Ephraim is oppressed, trampled in judgment, intent on pursuing idols.
- 12 Therefore I'm pus to Ephraim, dry rot in the house of Judah.
- 12 I am like a moth to Ephraim, like rot to the people of Judah.
- 13 "When Ephraim saw he was sick and Judah saw his pus-filled sores, Ephraim went running to Assyria, went for help to the big king. But he can't heal you. He can't cure your oozing sores.
- 13 When Ephraim saw his sickness, and Judah his sores, then Ephraim turned to Assyria, and sent to the great king for help. But he is not able to cure you, not able to heal your sores.
- 14 "I'm a grizzly charging Ephraim, a grizzly with cubs charging Judah. I'll rip them to pieces--yes, I will! No one can stop me now. I'll drag them off. No one can help them.
- 14 For I will be like a lion to Ephraim, like a great lion to Judah. I will tear them to pieces and go away; I will carry them off, with no one to rescue them.
- 15 Then I'll go back to where I came from until they come to their senses. When they finally hit rock bottom, maybe they'll come looking for me."
- 15 Then I will go back to my place until they admit their guilt. And they will seek my face; in their misery they will earnestly seek me."

Hosea 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Come on, let's go back to GOD. He hurt us, but he'll heal us. He hit us hard, but he'll put us right again.
- 1 Come, let us return to the LORD. He has torn us to pieces but he will heal us; he has injured us but he will bind up our wounds.
- 2 In a couple of days we'll feel better. By the third day he'll have made us brand-new, Alive and on our feet, fit to face him.

- 2 After two days he will revive us; on the third day he will restore us, that we may live in his presence.
- 3 We're ready to study GOD, eager for God-knowledge. As sure as dawn breaks, so sure is his daily arrival. He comes as rain comes, as spring rain refreshing the ground."
- 3 Let us acknowledge the LORD; let us press on to acknowledge him. As surely as the sun rises, he will appear; he will come to us like the winter rains, like the spring rains that water the earth."
- 4 "What am I to do with you, Ephraim? What do I make of you, Judah? Your declarations of love last no longer than morning mist and predawn dew.
- 4 What can I do with you, Ephraim? What can I do with you, Judah? Your love is like the morning mist, like the early dew that disappears.
- 5 That's why I use prophets to shake you to attention, why my words cut you to the quick: To wake you up to my judgment blazing like light.
- 5 Therefore I cut you in pieces with my prophets, I killed you with the words of my mouth; my judgments flashed like lightning upon you.
- 6 I'm after love that lasts, not more religion. I want you to know GOD, not go to more prayer meetings.
- 6 For I desire mercy, not sacrifice, and acknowledgment of God rather than burnt offerings.
- 7 You broke the covenant--just like Adam! You broke faith with me--ungrateful wretches!
- 7 Like Adam, they have broken the covenant-- they were unfaithful to me there.
- 8 "Gilead has become Crime City-- blood on the sidewalks, blood on the streets.
- 8 Gilead is a city of wicked men, stained with footprints of blood.
- 9 It used to be robbers who mugged pedestrians. Now it's gangs of priests Assaulting worshipers on their way to Shechem. Nothing is sacred to them.
- 9 As marauders lie in ambush for a man, so do bands of priests; they murder on the road to Shechem, committing shameful crimes.
- 10 "I saw a shocking thing in the country of Israel: Ephraim worshiping in a religious whorehouse, and Israel in the mud right there with him.

- 10 I have seen a horrible thing in the house of Israel. There Ephraim is given to prostitution and Israel is defiled.
- 11 "You're as bad as the worst of them, Judah. You've been sowing wild oats. Now it's harvest time.
- 11 Also for you, Judah, a harvest is appointed. Whenever I would restore the fortunes of my people,

Hosea 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Every time I gave Israel a fresh start, wiped the slate clean and got them going again, Ephraim soon filled the slate with new sins, the treachery of Samaria written out in bold print. Two-faced and double-tongued, they steal you blind, pick you clean.
- 1 whenever I would heal Israel, the sins of Ephraim are exposed and the crimes of Samaria revealed. They practice deceit, thieves break into houses, bandits rob in the streets;
- 2 It never crosses their mind that I keep account of their every crime. They're mud-spattered head to toe with the residue of sin. I see who they are and what they've done.
- 2 but they do not realize that I remember all their evil deeds. Their sins engulf them; they are always before me.
- 3 "They entertain the king with their evil circus, delight the princes with their acrobatic lies.
- 3 They delight the king with their wickedness, the princes with their lies.
- 4 They're a bunch of overheated adulterers, like an oven that holds its heat From the kneading of the dough to the rising of the bread.
- 4 They are all adulterers, burning like an oven whose fire the baker need not stir from the kneading of the dough till it rises.
- 5 On the royal holiday the princes get drunk on wine and the frenzy of the mocking mob.
- 5 On the day of the festival of our king the princes become inflamed with wine, and he joins hands with the mockers.
- 6 They're like wood stoves, red-hot with lust. Through the night their passion is banked; in the morning it blazes up, flames hungrily licking.

- 6 Their hearts are like an oven; they approach him with intrigue. Their passion smolders all night; in the morning it blazes like a flaming fire.
- 7 Murderous and volcanic, they incinerate their rulers. Their kings fall one by one, and no one pays any attention to me.
- 7 All of them are hot as an oven; they devour their rulers. All their kings fall, and none of them calls on me.
- 8 "Ephraim mingles with the pagans, dissipating himself. Ephraim is half-baked.
- 8 Ephraim mixes with the nations; Ephraim is a flat cake not turned over.
- 9 Strangers suck him dry but he doesn't even notice. His hair has turned gray-- he doesn't notice.
- 9 Foreigners sap his strength, but he does not realize it. His hair is sprinkled with gray, but he does not notice.
- 10 Bloated by arrogance, big as a house, Israel's a public disgrace. Israel lumbers along oblivious to GOD, despite all the signs, ignoring GOD.
- 10 Israel's arrogance testifies against him, but despite all this he does not return to the LORD his God or search for him.
- 11 "Ephraim is bird-brained, mindless, clueless, First chirping after Egypt, then fluttering after Assyria.
- 11 Ephraim is like a dove, easily deceived and senseless-- now calling to Egypt, now turning to Assyria.
- 12 I'll throw my net over them. I'll clip their wings. I'll teach them to mind me!
- 12 When they go, I will throw my net over them; I will pull them down like birds of the air. When I hear them flocking together, I will catch them.
- 13 Doom! They've run away from home. Now they're really in trouble! They've defied me. And I'm supposed to help them while they feed me a line of lies?
- 13 Woe to them, because they have strayed from me! Destruction to them, because they have rebelled against me! I long to redeem them but they speak lies against me.
- 14 Instead of crying out to me in heartfelt prayer, they whoop it up in bed with their whores, Gash themselves bloody in their sex-and-religion orgies, but turn their backs on me.

- 14 They do not cry out to me from their hearts but wail upon their beds.
They gather together for grain and new wine but turn away from me.
- 15 I'm the one who gave them good minds and healthy bodies, and how am I repaid? With evil scheming!
- 15 I trained them and strengthened them, but they plot evil against me.
- 16 They turn, but not to me-- turn here, then there, like a weather vane.
Their rulers will be cut down, murdered-- just deserts for their mocking blasphemies. And the final sentence? Ridicule in the court of world opinion.
- 16 They do not turn to the Most High; they are like a faulty bow. Their leaders will fall by the sword because of their insolent words. For this they will be ridiculed in the land of Egypt.

Hosea 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Blow the trumpet! Sound the alarm! Vultures are circling over God's people Who have broken my covenant and defied my revelation.
- 1 Put the trumpet to your lips! An eagle is over the house of the LORD because the people have broken my covenant and rebelled against my law.
- 2 Predictably, Israel cries out, 'My God! We know you!' But they don't act like it.
- 2 Israel cries out to me, 'O our God, we acknowledge you!'
- 3 Israel will have nothing to do with what's good, and now the enemy is after them.
- 3 But Israel has rejected what is good; an enemy will pursue him.
- 4 "They crown kings, but without asking me. They set up princes but don't let me in on it. Instead, they make idols, using silver and gold, idols that will be their ruin.
- 4 They set up kings without my consent; they choose princes without my approval. With their silver and gold they make idols for themselves to their own destruction.
- 5 Throw that gold calf-god on the trash heap, Samaria! I'm seething with anger against that rubbish! How long before they shape up?

- 5 Throw out your calf-idol, O Samaria! My anger burns against them. How long will they be incapable of purity?
- 6 And they're Israelites! A sculptor made that thing-- it's not God. That Samaritan calf will be broken to bits.
- 6 They are from Israel! This calf--a craftsman has made it; it is not God. It will be broken in pieces, that calf of Samaria.
- 7 Look at them! Planting wind-seeds, they'll harvest tornadoes. Wheat with no head produces no flour. And even if it did, strangers would gulp it down.
- 7 They sow the wind and reap the whirlwind. The stalk has no head; it will produce no flour. Were it to yield grain, foreigners would swallow it up.
- 8 Israel is swallowed up and spit out. Among the pagans they're a piece of junk.
- 8 Israel is swallowed up; now she is among the nations like a worthless thing.
- 9 They trotted off to Assyria: Why, even wild donkeys stick to their own kind, but donkey-Ephraim goes out and pays to get lovers.
- 9 For they have gone up to Assyria like a wild donkey wandering alone. Ephraim has sold herself to lovers.
- 10 Now, because of their whoring life among the pagans, I'm going to gather them together and confront them. They're going to reap the consequences soon, feel what it's like to be oppressed by the big king.
- 10 Although they have sold themselves among the nations, I will now gather them together. They will begin to waste away under the oppression of the mighty king.
- 11 "Ephraim has built a lot of altars, and then uses them for sinning. Can you believe it? Altars for sinning!
- 11 Though Ephraim built many altars for sin offerings, these have become altars for sinning.
- 12 I write out my revelation for them in detail and they pretend they can't read it.
- 12 I wrote for them the many things of my law, but they regarded them as something alien.
- 13 They offer sacrifices to me and then they feast on the meat. GOD is not pleased! I'm fed up--I'll keep remembering their guilt. I'll punish their sins and send them back to Egypt.

- 13 They offer sacrifices given to me and they eat the meat, but the LORD is not pleased with them. Now he will remember their wickedness and punish their sins: They will return to Egypt.
- 14 Israel has forgotten his Maker and gotten busy making palaces. Judah has gone in for a lot of fortress cities. I'm sending fire on their cities to burn down their fortifications."
- 14 Israel has forgotten his Maker and built palaces; Judah has fortified many towns. But I will send fire upon their cities that will consume their fortresses."

Hosea 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Don't waste your life in wild orgies, Israel. Don't party away your life with the heathen. You walk away from your God at the drop of a hat and like a whore sell yourself promiscuously at every sex-and-religion party on the street.
- 1 Do not rejoice, O Israel; do not be jubilant like the other nations. For you have been unfaithful to your God; you love the wages of a prostitute at every threshing floor.
- 2 All that party food won't fill you up. You'll end up hungrier than ever.
- 2 Threshing floors and winepresses will not feed the people; the new wine will fail them.
- 3 At this rate you'll not last long in GOD's land: Some of you are going to end up bankrupt in Egypt. Some of you will be disillusioned in Assyria.
- 3 They will not remain in the LORD's land; Ephraim will return to Egypt and eat unclean food in Assyria.
- 4 As refugees in Egypt and Assyria, you won't have much chance to worship GOD-- Sentenced to rations of bread and water, and your souls polluted by the spirit-dirty air. You'll be starved for GOD, exiled from GOD's own country.
- 4 They will not pour out wine offerings to the LORD, nor will their sacrifices please him. Such sacrifices will be to them like the bread of mourners; all who eat them will be unclean. This food will be for themselves; it will not come into the temple of the LORD.

- 5 Will you be homesick for the old Holy Days? Will you miss festival worship of GOD?
- 5 What will you do on the day of your appointed feasts, on the festival days of the LORD?
- 6 Be warned! When you escape from the frying pan of disaster, you'll fall into the fire of Egypt. Egypt will give you a fine funeral! What use will all your god-inspired silver be then as you eke out a living in a field of weeds?
- 6 Even if they escape from destruction, Egypt will gather them, and Memphis will bury them. Their treasures of silver will be taken over by briars, and thorns will overrun their tents.
- 7 Time's up. Doom's at the doorstep. It's payday! Did Israel bluster, "The prophet is crazy! The 'man of the Spirit' is nuts!?" Think again. Because of your great guilt, you're in big trouble.
- 7 The days of punishment are coming, the days of reckoning are at hand. Let Israel know this. Because your sins are so many and your hostility so great, the prophet is considered a fool, the inspired man a maniac.
- 8 The prophet is looking out for Ephraim, working under God's orders. But everyone is trying to trip him up. He's hated right in God's house, of all places.
- 8 The prophet, along with my God, is the watchman over Ephraim, yet snares await him on all his paths, and hostility in the house of his God.
- 9 The people are going from bad to worse, rivaling that ancient and unspeakable crime at Gibeah. God's keeping track of their guilt. He'll make them pay for their sins.
- 9 They have sunk deep into corruption, as in the days of Gibeah. God will remember their wickedness and punish them for their sins.
- 10 "Long ago when I came upon Israel, it was like finding grapes out in the desert. When I found your ancestors, it was like finding a fig tree bearing fruit for the first time. But when they arrived at Baal-peor, that pagan shrine, they took to sin like a pig to filth, wallowing in the mud with their newfound friends.
- 10 When I found Israel, it was like finding grapes in the desert; when I saw your fathers, it was like seeing the early fruit on the fig tree. But when they came to Baal Peor, they consecrated themselves to that shameful idol and became as vile as the thing they loved.

- 11 Ephraim is fickle and scattered, like a flock of blackbirds, their beauty dissipated in confusion and clamor, frenetic and noisy, frigid and barren, and nothing to show for it--neither conception nor childbirth.
- 11 Ephraim's glory will fly away like a bird-- no birth, no pregnancy, no conception.
- 12 Even if they did give birth, I'd declare them unfit parents and take away their children! Yes indeed--a black day for them when I turn my back and walk off!
- 12 Even if they rear children, I will bereave them of every one. Woe to them when I turn away from them!
- 13 I see Ephraim letting his children run wild. He might just as well take them and kill them outright!"
- 13 I have seen Ephraim, like Tyre, planted in a pleasant place. But Ephraim will bring out their children to the slayer."
- 14 Give it to them, GOD! But what? Give them a dried-up womb and shriveled breasts.
- 14 Give them, O LORD-- what will you give them? Give them wombs that miscarry and breasts that are dry.
- 15 "All their evil came out into the open at the pagan shrine at Gilgal. Oh, how I hated them there! Because of their evil practices, I'll kick them off my land. I'm wasting no more love on them. Their leaders are a bunch of rebellious adolescents.
- 15 Because of all their wickedness in Gilgal, I hated them there. Because of their sinful deeds, I will drive them out of my house. I will no longer love them; all their leaders are rebellious.
- 16 Ephraim is hit hard-- roots withered, no more fruit. Even if by some miracle they had children, the dear babies wouldn't live--I'd make sure of that!"
- 16 Ephraim is blighted, their root is withered, they yield no fruit. Even if they bear children, I will slay their cherished offspring."
- 17 My God has washed his hands of them. They wouldn't listen. They're doomed to be wanderers, vagabonds among the godless nations.
- 17 My God will reject them because they have not obeyed him; they will be wanderers among the nations.

Hosea 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Israel was once a lush vine, bountiful in grapes. The more lavish the harvest, the more promiscuous the worship. The more money they got, the more they squandered on gods-in-their-own-image.
- 1 Israel was a spreading vine; he brought forth fruit for himself. As his fruit increased, he built more altars; as his land prospered, he adorned his sacred stones.
- 2 Their sweet smiles are sheer lies. They're guilty as sin. God will smash their worship shrines, pulverize their god-images.
- 2 Their heart is deceitful, and now they must bear their guilt. The LORD will demolish their altars and destroy their sacred stones.
- 3 They go around saying, "Who needs a king? We couldn't care less about GOD, so why bother with a king? What difference would he make?"
- 3 Then they will say, "We have no king because we did not revere the LORD. But even if we had a king, what could he do for us?"
- 4 They talk big, lie through their teeth, make deals. But their high-sounding words turn out to be empty words, litter in the gutters.
- 4 They make many promises, take false oaths and make agreements; therefore lawsuits spring up like poisonous weeds in a plowed field.
- 5 The people of Samaria travel over to Crime City to worship the golden calf-god. They go all out, prancing and hollering, taken in by their showmen priests. They act so important around the calf-god, but are oblivious to the sham, the shame.
- 5 The people who live in Samaria fear for the calf-idol of Beth Aven. Its people will mourn over it, and so will its idolatrous priests, those who had rejoiced over its splendor, because it is taken from them into exile.
- 6 They have plans to take it to Assyria, present it as a gift to the great king. And so Ephraim makes a fool of himself, disgraces Israel with his stupid idols.
- 6 It will be carried to Assyria as tribute for the great king. Ephraim will be disgraced; Israel will be ashamed of its wooden idols.
- 7 Samaria is history. Its king is a dead branch floating down the river.

- 7 Samaria and its king will float away like a twig on the surface of the waters.
- 8 Israel's favorite sin centers will all be torn down. Thistles and crabgrass will decorate their ruined altars. Then they'll say to the mountains, "Bury us!" and to the hills, "Fall on us!"
- 8 The high places of wickedness will be destroyed-- it is the sin of Israel. Thorns and thistles will grow up and cover their altars. Then they will say to the mountains, "Cover us!" and to the hills, "Fall on us!"
- 9 You got your start in sin at Gibeah-- that ancient, unspeakable, shocking sin-- And you've been at it ever since. And Gibeah will mark the end of it in a war to end all the sinning.
- 9 Since the days of Gibeah, you have sinned, O Israel, and there you have remained. Did not war overtake the evildoers in Gibeah?
- 10 I'll come to teach them a lesson. Nations will gang up on them, Making them learn the hard way the sum of Gibeah plus Gibeah.
- 10 When I please, I will punish them; nations will be gathered against them to put them in bonds for their double sin.
- 11 Ephraim was a trained heifer that loved to thresh. Passing by and seeing her strong, sleek neck, I wanted to harness Ephraim, Put Ephraim to work in the fields-- Judah plowing, Jacob harrowing:
- 11 Ephraim is a trained heifer that loves to thresh; so I will put a yoke on her fair neck. I will drive Ephraim, Judah must plow, and Jacob must break up the ground.
- 12 Sow righteousness, reap love. It's time to till the ready earth, it's time to dig in with GOD, Until he arrives with righteousness ripe for harvest.
- 12 Sow for yourselves righteousness, reap the fruit of unfailing love, and break up your unplowed ground; for it is time to seek the LORD, until he comes and showers righteousness on you.
- 13 But instead you plowed wicked ways, reaped a crop of evil and ate a salad of lies. You thought you could do it all on your own, flush with weapons and manpower.
- 13 But you have planted wickedness, you have reaped evil, you have eaten the fruit of deception. Because you have depended on your own strength and on your many warriors,
- 14 But the volcano of war will erupt among your people. All your defense posts will be leveled As viciously as king Shalman leveled the town of

- Beth-arba, When mothers and their babies were smashed on the rocks.
- 14 the roar of battle will rise against your people, so that all your fortresses will be devastated-- as Shalman devastated Beth Arbel on the day of battle, when mothers were dashed to the ground with their children.
- 15 That's what's ahead for you, you so-called people of God, because of your off-the-charts evil. Some morning you're going to wake up and find Israel, king and kingdom, a blank--nothing.
- 15 Thus will it happen to you, O Bethel, because your wickedness is great. When that day dawns, the king of Israel will be completely destroyed.

Hosea 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 "When Israel was only a child, I loved him. I called out, 'My son!'--called him out of Egypt.
- 1 When Israel was a child, I loved him, and out of Egypt I called my son.
- 2 But when others called him, he ran off and left me. He worshiped the popular sex gods, he played at religion with toy gods.
- 2 But the more I called Israel, the further they went from me. They sacrificed to the Baals and they burned incense to images.
- 3 Still, I stuck with him. I led Ephraim. I rescued him from human bondage, But he never acknowledged my help,
- 3 It was I who taught Ephraim to walk, taking them by the arms; but they did not realize it was I who healed them.
- 4 never admitted that I was the one pulling his wagon, That I lifted him, like a baby, to my cheek, that I bent down to feed him.
- 4 I led them with cords of human kindness, with ties of love; I lifted the yoke from their neck and bent down to feed them.
- 5 Now he wants to go back to Egypt or go over to Assyria-- anything but return to me!
- 5 Will they not return to Egypt and will not Assyria rule over them because they refuse to repent?
- 6 That's why his cities are unsafe--the murder rate skyrockets and every plan to improve things falls to pieces.

- 6 Swords will flash in their cities, will destroy the bars of their gates and put an end to their plans.
- 7 My people are hell-bent on leaving me. They pray to god Baal for help. He doesn't lift a finger to help them.
- 7 My people are determined to turn from me. Even if they call to the Most High, he will by no means exalt them.
- 8 But how can I give up on you, Ephraim? How can I turn you loose, Israel? How can I leave you to be ruined like Admah, devastated like luckless Zeboim? I can't bear to even think such thoughts. My insides churn in protest.
- 8 How can I give you up, Ephraim? How can I hand you over, Israel? How can I treat you like Admah? How can I make you like Zeboim? My heart is changed within me; all my compassion is aroused.
- 9 And so I'm not going to act on my anger. I'm not going to destroy Ephraim. And why? Because I am God and not a human. I'm The Holy One and I'm here--in your very midst.
- 9 I will not carry out my fierce anger, nor will I turn and devastate Ephraim. For I am God, and not man-- the Holy One among you. I will not come in wrath.
- 10 "The people will end up following GOD. I will roar like a lion-- Oh, how I'll roar! My frightened children will come running from the west.
- 10 They will follow the LORD; he will roar like a lion. When he roars, his children will come trembling from the west.
- 11 Like frightened birds they'll come from Egypt, from Assyria like scared doves. I'll move them back into their homes." GOD's Word!
- 11 They will come trembling like birds from Egypt, like doves from Assyria. I will settle them in their homes," declares the LORD.
- 12 Ephraim tells lies right and left. Not a word of Israel can be trusted. Judah, meanwhile, is no better, addicted to cheap gods.
- 12 Ephraim has surrounded me with lies, the house of Israel with deceit. And Judah is unruly against God, even against the faithful Holy One.

Hosea 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 Ephraim, obsessed with god-fantasies, chases ghosts and phantoms. He tells lies nonstop, soul-destroying lies. Both Ephraim and Judah made deals with Assyria and tried to get an inside track with Egypt.
- 1 Ephraim feeds on the wind; he pursues the east wind all day and multiplies lies and violence. He makes a treaty with Assyria and sends olive oil to Egypt.
- 2 GOD is bringing charges against Israel. Jacob's children are hauled into court to be punished.
- 2 The LORD has a charge to bring against Judah; he will punish Jacob according to his ways and repay him according to his deeds.
- 3 In the womb, that heel, Jacob, got the best of his brother. When he grew up, he tried to get the best of GOD.
- 3 In the womb he grasped his brother's heel; as a man he struggled with God.
- 4 But GOD would not be bested. GOD bested him. Brought to his knees, Jacob wept and prayed. GOD found him at Bethel. That's where he spoke with him.
- 4 He struggled with the angel and overcame him; he wept and begged for his favor. He found him at Bethel and talked with him there--
- 5 GOD is God-of-the-Angel-Armies, GOD-Revealed, GOD-Known.
- 5 the LORD God Almighty, the LORD is his name of renown!
- 6 What are you waiting for? Return to your God! Commit yourself in love, in justice! Wait for your God, and don't give up on him--ever!
- 6 But you must return to your God; maintain love and justice, and wait for your God always.
- 7 The businessmen engage in wholesale fraud. They love to rip people off!
- 7 The merchant uses dishonest scales; he loves to defraud.
- 8 Ephraim boasted, "Look, I'm rich! I've made it big! And look how well I've covered my tracks: not a hint of fraud, not a sign of sin!"
- 8 Ephraim boasts, "I am very rich; I have become wealthy. With all my wealth they will not find in me any iniquity or sin."
- 9 "But not so fast! I'm GOD, your God! Your God from the days in Egypt! I'm going to put you back to living in tents, as in the old days when you worshiped in the wilderness.
- 9 I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt; I will make you live in tents again, as in the days of your appointed feasts.

- 10 I speak through the prophets to give clear pictures of the way things are. Using prophets, I tell revealing stories.
- 10 I spoke to the prophets, gave them many visions and told parables through them."
- 11 I show Gilead rampant with religious scandal and Gilgal teeming with empty-headed religion. I expose their worship centers as stinking piles of garbage in their gardens."
- 11 Is Gilead wicked? Its people are worthless! Do they sacrifice bulls in Gilgal? Their altars will be like piles of stones on a plowed field.
- 12 Are you going to repeat the life of your ancestor Jacob? He ran off guilty to Aram, Then sold his soul to get ahead, and made it big through treachery and deceit.
- 12 Jacob fled to the country of Aram; Israel served to get a wife, and to pay for her he tended sheep.
- 13 Your real identity is formed through God-sent prophets, who led you out of Egypt and served as faithful pastors.
- 13 The LORD used a prophet to bring Israel up from Egypt, by a prophet he cared for him.
- 14 As it is, Ephraim has continually and inexcusably insulted God. Now he has to pay for his life-destroying ways. His Master will do to him what he has done.
- 14 But Ephraim has bitterly provoked him to anger; his Lord will leave upon him the guilt of his bloodshed and will repay him for his contempt.

Hosea 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 God once let loose against Ephraim a terrifying sentence against Israel: Caught and convicted in the lewd sex-worship of Baal--they died!
- 1 When Ephraim spoke, men trembled; he was exalted in Israel. But he became guilty of Baal worship and died.
- 2 And now they're back in the sin business again, manufacturing god-images they can use, Religion customized to taste. Professionals see to it: Anything you want in a god you can get. Can you believe it? They

- sacrifice live babies to these dead gods-- kill living babies and kiss golden calves!
- 2 Now they sin more and more; they make idols for themselves from their silver, cleverly fashioned images, all of them the work of craftsmen. It is said of these people, "They offer human sacrifice and kiss the calf-idols."
- 3 And now there's nothing left to these people: hollow men, desiccated women, Like scraps of paper blown down the street, like smoke in a gusty wind.
- 3 Therefore they will be like the morning mist, like the early dew that disappears, like chaff swirling from a threshing floor, like smoke escaping through a window.
- 4 "I'm still your GOD, the God who saved you out of Egypt. I'm the only real God you've ever known. I'm the one and only God who delivers.
- 4 But I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of Egypt. You shall acknowledge no God but me, no Savior except me.
- 5 I took care of you during the wilderness hard times, those years when you had nothing.
- 5 I cared for you in the desert, in the land of burning heat.
- 6 I took care of you, took care of all your needs, gave you everything you needed. You were spoiled. You thought you didn't need me. You forgot me.
- 6 When I fed them, they were satisfied; when they were satisfied, they became proud; then they forgot me.
- 7 "I'll charge them like a lion, like a leopard stalking in the brush.
- 7 So I will come upon them like a lion, like a leopard I will lurk by the path.
- 8 I'll jump them like a sow grizzled robbed of her cubs. I'll rip out their guts. Coyotes will make a meal of them. Crows will clean their bones.
- 8 Like a bear robbed of her cubs, I will attack them and rip them open. Like a lion I will devour them; a wild animal will tear them apart.
- 9 I'm going to destroy you, Israel. Who is going to stop me?
- 9 You are destroyed, O Israel, because you are against me, against your helper.
- 10 Where is your trusty king you thought would save you? Where are all the local leaders you wanted so badly? All these rulers you insisted on having, demanding, 'Give me a king! Give me leaders!'

- 10 Where is your king, that he may save you? Where are your rulers in all your towns, of whom you said, 'Give me a king and princes'?
- 11 Well, long ago I gave you a king, but I wasn't happy about it. Now, fed up, I've gotten rid of him.
- 11 So in my anger I gave you a king, and in my wrath I took him away.
- 12 I have a detailed record of your infidelities-- Ephraim's sin documented and stored in a safe-deposit box.
- 12 The guilt of Ephraim is stored up, his sins are kept on record.
- 13 "When birth pangs signaled it was time to be born, Ephraim was too stupid to come out of the womb. When the passage into life opened up, he didn't show.
- 13 Pains as of a woman in childbirth come to him, but he is a child without wisdom; when the time arrives, he does not come to the opening of the womb.
- 14 Shall I intervene and pull them into life? Shall I snatch them from a certain death? Who is afraid of you, Death? Who cares about your threats, Tomb? In the end I'm abolishing regret, banishing sorrow,
- 14 I will ransom them from the power of the grave; I will redeem them from death. Where, O death, are your plagues? Where, O grave, is your destruction? I will have no compassion,
- 15 Even though Ephraim ran wild, the black sheep of the family. "GOD's tornado is on its way, roaring out of the desert. It will devastate the country, leaving a trail of ruin and wreckage. The cities will be gutted, dear possessions gone for good.
- 15 even though he thrives among his brothers. An east wind from the LORD will come, blowing in from the desert; his spring will fail and his well dry up. His storehouse will be plundered of all its treasures.
- 16 Now Samaria has to face the charges because she has rebelled against her God: Her people will be killed, babies smashed on the rocks, pregnant women ripped open."
- 16 The people of Samaria must bear their guilt, because they have rebelled against their God. They will fall by the sword; their little ones will be dashed to the ground, their pregnant women ripped open."

Hosea 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 O Israel, come back! Return to your GOD! You're down but you're not out.
- 1 Return, O Israel, to the LORD your God. Your sins have been your downfall!
- 2 Prepare your confession and come back to GOD. Pray to him, "Take away our sin, accept our confession. Receive as restitution our repentant prayers.
- 2 Take words with you and return to the LORD. Say to him: "Forgive all our sins and receive us graciously, that we may offer the fruit of our lips.
- 3 Assyria won't save us; horses won't get us where we want to go. We'll never again say 'our god' to something we've made or made up. You're our last hope. Is it not true that in you the orphan finds mercy?"
- 3 Assyria cannot save us; we will not mount war-horses. We will never again say 'Our gods' to what our own hands have made, for in you the fatherless find compassion."
- 4 "I will heal their waywardness. I will love them lavishly. My anger is played out.
- 4 I will heal their waywardness and love them freely, for my anger has turned away from them.
- 5 I will make a fresh start with Israel. He'll burst into bloom like a crocus in the spring. He'll put down deep oak tree roots,
- 5 I will be like the dew to Israel; he will blossom like a lily. Like a cedar of Lebanon he will send down his roots;
- 6 he'll become a forest of oaks! He'll become splendid--like a giant sequoia, his fragrance like a grove of cedars!
- 6 his young shoots will grow. His splendor will be like an olive tree, his fragrance like a cedar of Lebanon.
- 7 Those who live near him will be blessed by him, be blessed and prosper like golden grain. Everyone will be talking about them, spreading their fame as the vintage children of God.
- 7 Men will dwell again in his shade. He will flourish like the grain. He will blossom like a vine, and his fame will be like the wine from Lebanon.
- 8 Ephraim is finished with gods that are no-gods. From now on I'm the one who answers and satisfies him. I am like a luxuriant fruit tree.

Everything you need is to be found in me."

- 8 O Ephraim, what more have I to do with idols? I will answer him and care for him. I am like a green pine tree; your fruitfulness comes from me."
- 9 If you want to live well, make sure you understand all of this. If you know what's good for you, you'll learn this inside and out. GOD's paths get you where you want to go. Right-living people walk them easily; wrong-living people are always tripping and stumbling.
- 9 Who is wise? He will realize these things. Who is discerning? He will understand them. The ways of the LORD are right; the righteous walk in them, but the rebellious stumble in them.